

Josh Persi

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I am a data scientist with five years of professional experience. Over this time, I developed end-to-end productionized pipelines for data analysis. I used my strong technical skills in coding with R, Python, and SQL to create high-value products for diverse stakeholders and senior management. My work has entailed modelling, statistics, and experimental design, and been fast, robust, and reproducible from my use of unit testing and version control.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: R, Python, SQL (PL-SQL, T-SQL), Markdown, YAML, Typst, Bash

Developer Tools: Git, Azure Devops, GitHub, Quarto, VS Code / Positron, Docker, WSL

Libraries: polars, duckdb, pyarrow, pytask, pytest, uv, pandas, numpy

EXPERIENCE

Science Specialist

Ottawa, ON

Canadian Food Inspection Agency

Oct. 2021 – Present

- Developed productionized ETL and analytical pipelines in R and Python to download and augment data
- Contributed to the design of complex survey programs via sample size calculations
- Applied time series models (ARIMA) to forecast the number of business activities.
- Applied NLP (stemming, tokenization, part-of-speech) and LLMs to extract structure from free text data
- Used Git to maintain version-controlled project histories; using rebases, pull-requests, and merges
- Used unit testing, parallel tests, test fixtures, and snapshot tests, to deliver high-quality code
- Transformed data via scaling, decomposition, encoding, missing value imputation, *.etc* via pipelines
- Built and maintained multi-functional relationships with policy makers, scientists, and data engineers
- Quantified the risk of adverse effects (biological pest outbreaks) to manage and prioritize risk
- Built minimal viable products as fast as possible for immediate input and iterative development
- Dove deep into policy strategies and business context to understand the data-science needs of the business

Assistant Field Botanist

Toronto, ON

Toronto Region Conservation Authority

Apr. 2021 – Oct. 2021

- Conducted botanical surveys throughout Toronto to document rare and invasive plant species

EDUCATION

McGill University

Montréal, QC

Master of Science, Department of Biology

Jan. 2018 – Dec. 2020

- Applied complex experimental design with consideration of controls, treatments, sample sizes, *.etc*
- Used generalized linear models in R to identify important predictors
- Used generalized linear mixed models to account for random effects due to spatiotemporal clustering
- Used stepwise model selection based on information criteria (*e.g.* AIC, BIC) to identify the optimal model

University of Guelph

Guelph, ON

Bachelor of Science in Environmental Sciences, Department of Integrative Biology

Sep. 2013 – Apr. 2017

- Designed a fully factorial experiment involving two predictors and several response variables
- Applied inferential tests (two-way ANCOVA) to identify the predictors with an impact on the response

PROJECTS

TidyTuesday

Aug. 2025 – Present

- Participated in weekly exercises to visualize a new dataset in a novel or insightful way

Data Science Learning Community

Feb. 2024 – Present

- Participated in weekly bookclubs on topics such as data visualization, devops, and machine learning